Namespacing

Namespaces

Namespaces in PHP are designed to resolve scope problems in large PHP libraries

- Simplify development in object oriented environment
- Clears the code – no long class names

In PHP all classes declarations are global

- Namespaces allow to have two classes with same name
- Old approach was adding prefixes to class names (Like the `mysql_*` functions)

Namespace Definition

Namespaces are declared with the `namespace` keyword

- Should be always in the beginning of the file

```
<?
namespace Project;

class MyTemplate { … }
function print_headers () { … }
…
?>
```

Namespaces

Classes, function and etc. in a namespace are automatically prefixed with the name of the namespace

- So in the example we would use `Project\MyTemplate` to access the class

Namespaces – Example

```
// file Project.php
namespace Project;
// declare base classes and etc.
…
// file project/db.php;
namespace Project\DB;
// declare DB interface for work with database
…
// file project/db/mysql.php
namespace Project\DB\MySQL;
// implement the DB interface for mysql
…
// file project/db/oracle.php
Namespace Project\DB\Oracle;
// implement the DB interface for Oracle
…
// somewhere in the project
require "project/db/mysql.php";
$a = new Project\DB\MySQL\Connection;
Project\DB\MySQL\connect();
```

Using Namespaces

The use operator allows aliasing namespaces names

```
use Project\DB\MySQL as DBLink;
$x = new DBLink\Connection;
DBLink\connect();
```

Global Namespace

By default PHP works in the global namespace

End of Topic